

09-23-2025 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=E3a0pnQSDQ4
Publication Date	2025-09-24T10:08:20Z
Target Category	mcs

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

Board/Council: Muncie Community Schools Board of Education

Meeting Date: (Transcript Analysis)

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(Omitted as no statutory public hearing or separate committee work session was held immediately prior to the call to order.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The presiding officer called the meeting to order, opening with a moment of silence and the Pledge of Allegiance [00:04:41](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Dr. O'Neal, Mr. Heer, Dr. Washford, Mr. Irvin, Mr. L, and Dr. Reynolds.
 - **Members Absent:** Mrs. Barnes Griffin.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly named by title in the opening roll call, but leading the proceedings.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Conducted a moment of silence and recited the Pledge of Allegiance 00:04:47.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** *(Not explicitly detailed in the transcript prior to substantive business, though standard procedural acknowledgments occurred).*
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:11:19 Presentation: Panther Pantry 10-Year Anniversary Update

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Deb (Pantry Coordinator/Representative).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Deb provided an update on the Panther Pantry, noting that it approaches its 10-year anniversary in February (originating at Southside 10 years ago and now expanding across 45 schools). She thanked donors and volunteers, noting high demand for non-perishable food items and sweatpants (sizes 10-12 up to 3X). Upcoming initiatives include a "Stuff the Bus" event at Payless and a new partnership with the Ball Hospital emergency room.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no board vote required.

00:19:18 Presentation: Muncie Central High School & Freshman Academy Launch

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Walker (Principal, Muncie Central High School), joined by teachers/team leads Ellie Coles, Jen Jensen, and Drew Sheretta.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Principal Walker and team presented updates on Muncie Central, highlighting the new "Bearcat Shoutout Chain" staff recognition program, rising graduation rates (projected above 90% for the class of 2025, the highest since 2019), and the newly launched Freshman Academy. The Freshman Academy utilizes a teaming model (four core teachers with common planning periods) and a mandatory "Freshman Seminar" course covering high school adjustment, typing skills (typing.com), silent sustained reading, graduation pathways, and organizational skills via physical agenda books. Funded partially by the George and Francis Ball Foundation, Ball Brothers Foundation, and the Black Rock Foundation.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no board vote required.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(No general public comment period featuring external community speakers was conducted during this portion of the transcript; presentations were limited to board members, district staff,

and invited program representatives like Deb and Scott Gorby).

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Dr. Reynolds provided district updates regarding the Muny Central campus construction, Department of Education visits to Longfellow, Garton, and Southview schools, homecoming festivities, the 1,000th high school football game against the Richmond Red Devils, fall athletic schedules, and upcoming enrollment count day (October 1st) followed by fall break starting October 6th 00:05:44.
 - Introduction of new staff member Scott Gorby, hired for a sixth-grade English position at Southside Middle School 00:10:03.
 - **Consent Agenda Approval:** The board reviewed and approved the consent agenda (including donations and personnel items).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 01:07:17.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned upon a motion and voice vote.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 01:08:42.
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